

Flora Cao

Design Engineer & HCI research intern | floracao.studio@gmail.com

EDUCATION

Parsons School of Design

BFA in Design and Technology

New York, NY

Expected May 2027

- GPA: 3.87/4
- Honors: Dean's List, Merit Scholarship
- Related Courses: Kinetic Modeling (A), Device Art Fabrication (A), JavaScript + OpenAI (A), Immersive Storytelling(A-), TouchDesigner (A-), Advanced Research Seminar: Visual Culture (A)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

Institute for Network Sciences and Cyberspace (Tsinghua University)

Research Intern

Remote

May 2026 – Present

- 2 research projects on AI inferential privacy

AI Thrust (Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Guangzhou)

Research Intern

Hybrid, Guangzhou

Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Cued Speech applications

INTERNSHIPS

Voibook

Engineer Intern

Hybrid, Guangzhou, China

Nov 2025 – Aug 2026

- Developed, fabricated and programmed an end-to-end multimodal robotic system for Mandarin Cued Speech data generation pipeline (natural language input → robotic gesture + WebM video + metadata in dataset)
- Applying for patent

Waybot Robotics

Industrial Design & Robotic Intern

Shanghai, China

May 2025 – Jul 2025

- Designed 13 robotic joint modules, including planetary, harmonic, and cycloidal actuator systems for embodied robotics applications
- Produced renderings and product catalogs for investor-facing materials used in the company's multi-million RMB Pre-A financing round

PORTS 1961

Creative Design Intern

Shanghai, China

May 2024 – Jul 2024

- Produced 50+ store-specific campaign visuals for retail locations, including spatial mockups of outdoor, large-format, and non-standard environments
- Designed and prototyped PR gift packaging through 3D modeling and visual storytelling workflows
- Assisted webpage layouts in Figma for online fashion retail based on reference studies of peer high-end fashion brands

SKILLS

Programming & Development: JavaScript, Python, C++, HTML/CSS, SSH, Git

Hardware & Fabrication: Arduino, 3D Printing, Laser Cutting, Woodworking, Soldering, Mold Making & Casting, Rapid Prototyping

Software: Fusion 360, Blender, TouchDesigner, Unity 3D, Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, Procreate, Final Cut Pro